

PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION AND AWARENESS REPORT

Cyber Security Task 2 – Future Interns

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Date of Submission: June 2026

CIN: FIT/MAY26/CS8637

Assessment Type: Phishing Email detection Assessment

INTRODUCTION

Phishing is one of the most common cyber threats used by attackers to steal sensitive information such as usernames, passwords, banking credentials, and personal data. These attacks are typically delivered through deceptive emails that appear to come from trusted organizations.

Attackers use social engineering techniques such as urgency, fear, rewards, and impersonation to manipulate users into clicking malicious links, downloading harmful attachments, or revealing confidential information.

The purpose of this project is to analyze phishing and legitimate email samples, identify phishing indicators, assess associated risks, and improve cybersecurity awareness.

AIM OF THE TASK

This task was performed to:

- Understand phishing attack techniques.
- Analyze real-world phishing email examples.
- Differentiate between phishing and legitimate emails.
- Identify warning signs and suspicious indicators.
- Assess security risks associated with phishing attacks.
- Promote safe email handling practices.

TOOLS & RESOURCES USED

Email Analysis Resources

- Google Jigsaw Phishing Quiz
- Email Header Inspection Techniques
- Browser-Based URL Analysis
- Cybersecurity Awareness Resources
- Microsoft Word
- GitHub

PHISHING EMAIL SAMPLES, ANALYSIS & RESPONSE

Sample 1: Fake Google Docs Share Email

Classification

PHISHING

Description

The email appears to be a Google document sharing notification. It attempts to convince users that someone has shared a document with them.

Why This Is Malicious

- Uses a personal email address instead of an official organization domain.
- Attempts to imitate Google Docs notifications.
- Encourages users to open a shared document.
- Sender identity cannot be verified.
- May redirect users to malicious content.

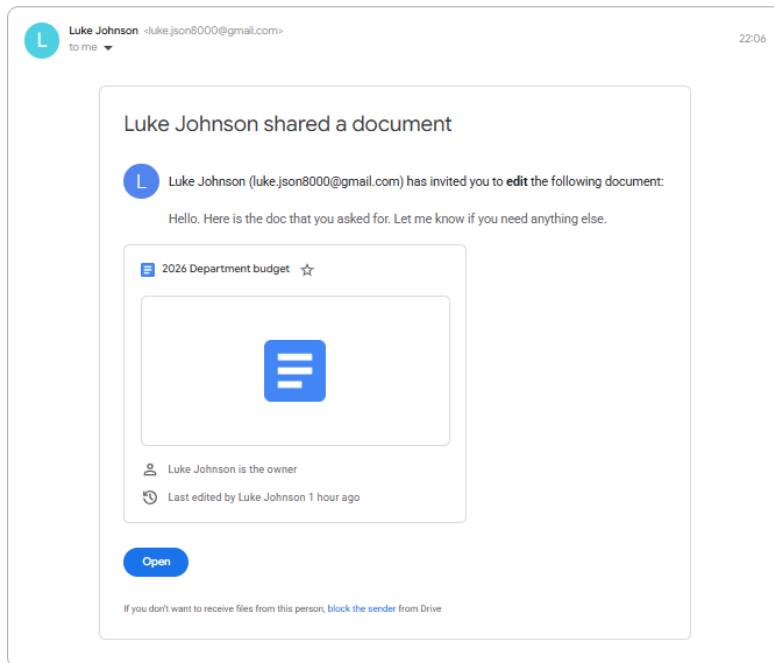
Risk Level

HIGH

Why High Risk?

- Can lead to credential theft.
- May distribute malware.
- Can compromise user accounts.

Screenshot



Sample 2: Coca-Cola Prize Scam Email

Classification

PHISHING

Description

The email claims that the recipient has been selected to receive a free reward or prize.

Why This Is Malicious

- Uses a well-known brand name to gain trust.
- Promises unrealistic rewards.
- Encourages users to click suspicious links.
- Uses social engineering techniques.
- Contains suspicious sender information.

Risk Level

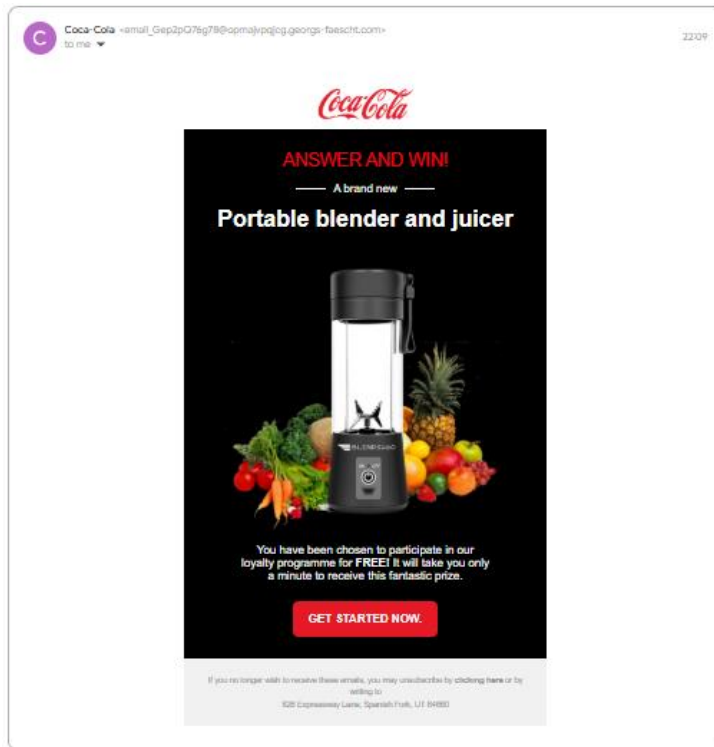
HIGH

Why High Risk?

- Can lead to financial fraud.
- May collect personal information.

- May redirect users to malicious websites.

Screenshot



Sample 3: Fake Google Password Alert

Classification

PHISHING

Description

The email claims that someone has obtained the user's password and urges immediate action.

Why This Is Malicious

- Uses fear-based tactics.
- Creates urgency.
- Encourages immediate password changes through provided links.
- Attempts to manipulate users emotionally.

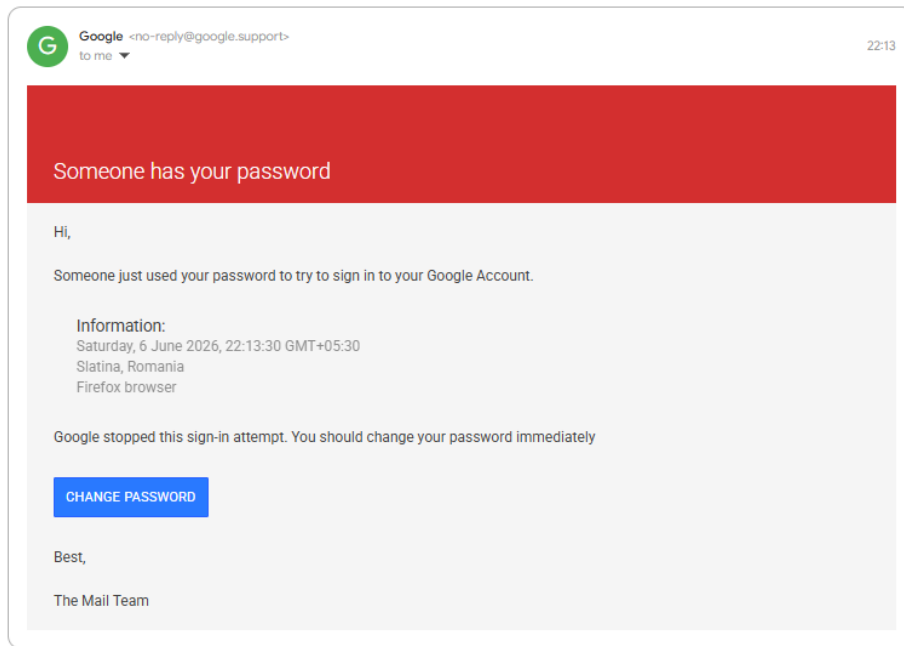
Risk Level

HIGH

Why High Risk?

- Can lead to account compromise.
- Credential theft.
- Identity theft.

Screenshot



LEGITIMATE EMAIL SAMPLES

Sample 4: Dropbox Storage Notification

Classification

LEGITIMATE

Description

The email notifies users about Dropbox storage usage and available upgrade options.

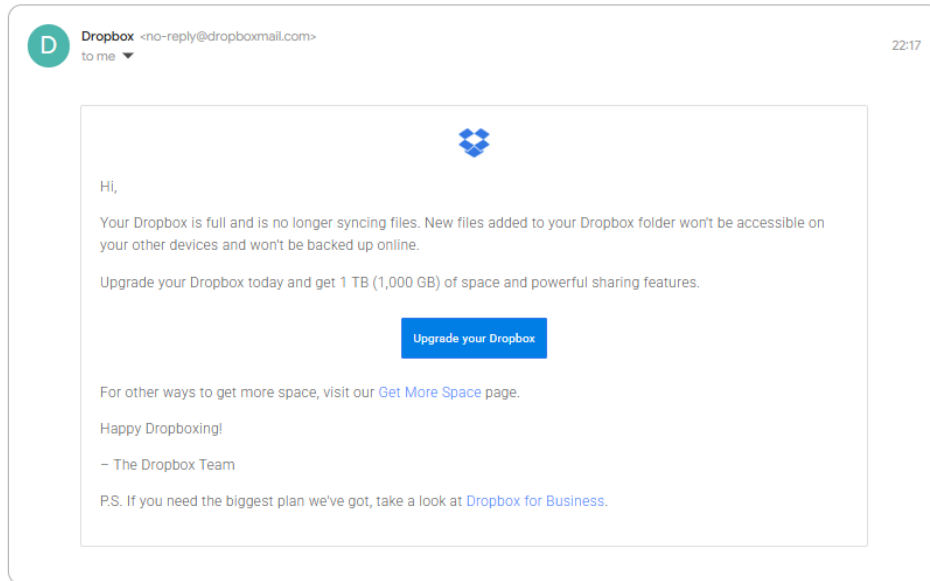
Why This Is Legitimate

- Uses official Dropbox branding.
- Professional formatting.
- No request for sensitive information.
- Communication is consistent with Dropbox services.

Risk Level

LOW

Screenshot



Sample 5: UPS Delivery Notification

Classification

LEGITIMATE

Description

The message provides shipment tracking information and delivery updates.

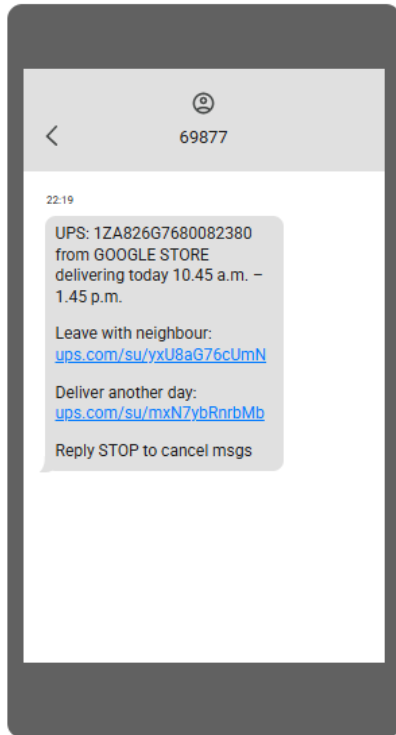
Why This Is Legitimate

- Informational purpose.
- No credential requests.
- Contains delivery-related details.
- No suspicious urgency tactics.

Risk Level

LOW

Screenshot



COMPARISON BETWEEN PHISHING AND LEGITIMATE EMAILS

Feature	Legitimate Emails	Phishing Emails
Sender Address	Trusted	Suspicious
Domain Name	Genuine	Fake or Misleading
Grammar	Professional	Often Poor
Hyperlinks	Safe	Suspicious
Urgency Tactics	Rare	Common
Credential Requests	No	Frequently Present
Trust Level	High	Low

RISK ASSESSMENT SUMMARY

Email Sample	Classification	Risk Level
Fake Google Docs Share	Phishing	High
Coca-Cola Prize Scam	Phishing	High
Fake Google Password Alert	Phishing	High
Dropbox Storage Notification	Legitimate	Low
UPS Delivery Notification	Legitimate	Low

SECURITY BEST PRACTICES

Recommended Practices

- Verify sender identity before responding.
- Check URLs before clicking links.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Use strong passwords.
- Keep software updated.
- Report suspicious emails immediately.
- Verify unexpected requests through official channels.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Through this project, practical knowledge was gained in:

- Phishing Email Detection
- Social Engineering Analysis
- Risk Assessment
- Cybersecurity Awareness
- Email Security
- Security Documentation
- Threat Identification

CONCLUSION

This project successfully analyzed both phishing and legitimate email samples to identify key differences and common phishing indicators. The phishing emails used techniques such as impersonation, urgency, fear tactics, and reward scams to manipulate users, while legitimate emails maintained trusted communication practices.